

The Young Family Financial Protection Checklist

The ten things to have handled before you worry about picking investments

New house, new baby, new job. Every big life event quietly adds financial risk before it adds wealth. This is the foundation checklist we walk families through first. Protection comes before portfolios. Work down the list, check what's done, and circle what isn't.

1 • Protect the People

- ☐ Life insurance on BOTH parents, sized to your real needs, not the round number work gave you. A stay-at-home parent needs coverage too: childcare, transportation, and household management are a real income to replace.
- ☐ Know your employer coverage multiple (1x or 2x salary is common) and whether it follows you if you change jobs. Most group policies don't.
- ☐ Disability income coverage. Through your working years, an injury or illness that stops your paycheck is more likely than an early death.

2 • Get the Paperwork Right

- ☐ Beneficiaries named and current on every account and policy: no ex-spouses, no blanks, contingents named. Never name a minor child directly without a plan for who manages the money.
- ☐ Core estate documents: will (with guardianship for the kids), power of attorney, healthcare directive.

3 • Build the Cushion

- ☐ Emergency fund of 3 to 6 months of real expenses, in savings you can reach, sized to your current mortgage or rent.
- ☐ A debt plan you both know: what you owe, what gets paid down first, and what you're comfortable carrying.

4 • Keep Building

- ☐ Retirement contributions still running, at least to any employer match. The kids' college fund does not come before your retirement.
- ☐ Old 401(k)s from previous jobs tracked down and consolidated so nothing is forgotten.
- ☐ One shared picture of the household money: accounts listed, both spouses know where everything lives and how to reach it.

5 • For Veteran Families (if this is you)

- ☐ If you separated recently: SGLI ended with your service. Confirm the replacement coverage actually got put in place, and compare VGLI against a private policy while your health is good.
- ☐ TSP accounted for: left in place deliberately, or rolled over correctly. Not forgotten.

Want help closing the circles? Free 20-minute family review. Virtual, no pitch.

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